



Youths For Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

Email: youthsaction31@gmail.com

Contact: 0748204272 / 0706072692

Address: Nakuru, Kenya

Post-Event Report: Kipkabus Forest Tree Planting Campaign 2025 – Phase One

1. Event Overview

- **Event Name:** Kipkabus Forest Tree Planting Campaign 2025 – Phase One
 - **Organized By:** Youths for Green Action – Kenya
 - **Dates:** 20th – 24th May 2025
 - **Location:** Kipkabus Forest, Elgeyo Marakwet County
 - **Number of Trees Planted:** 50,000 tree seedlings
 - **Total Acreage Covered:** 20.2 Ha (49.9 acres)
 - **Participants:** Community members, Government officials, KFS & CFA officers, Youths for Green Action team
 - **Sponsors and Project Patrons:** TagDev East Africa (Transforming African Agricultural Universities to Meaningfully Contribute to Africa's Growth and Development), German Imaging Technologies, Victoria Furniture / The Design Gallery
-

2. Background & Objective

This campaign marked the launch of the first phase of Youths for Green Action's reforestation mission at Kipkabus Forest. The campaign was effectively implemented with support from the Community Forest Association, local women, and youth groups.

Objectives:

- Restore forest cover with both exotic and indigenous trees
- Protect riparian ecosystems and promote climate resilience
- Foster local ownership of environmental stewardship and management
- Build stronger partnerships between public benefit organizations (YGAK), academic-development partners (TagDev East Africa), and the private sector (GIT, Design Gallery and Victoria Furnitures)

3. Execution Summary

The campaign was conducted over five days, beginning with an official launch on 20th May 2025 and concluding on 24th May 2025. A total of 50,000 tree seedlings were planted:

- 40,000 exotic species for reforestation and timber
- 10,000 indigenous species along riparian lands to preserve biodiversity and water sources

Over 100 community members attended the launch, with sustained participation throughout the week. The presence of high-level government and forest officials underscored the significance of the campaign.

TagDev East Africa's support was instrumental—not only in enabling logistics and coordination—but also in reinforcing the role of youth, education, and applied research in advancing sustainable forest restoration.

4. Participation

- **Community Members:** 100+ locals engaged throughout the planting period
 - **Government Officials:** See detailed list below
 - **Youths for Green Action:** Core organizing and facilitation team
 - **Women & Youth Groups:** Actively involved in daily planting efforts
 - **Community Forest Association (CFA):** Supported mobilization and coordination
 - **Project Sponsors & Patrons:** TagDev East Africa, German Imaging Technologies, Victoria Furniture, The Design Gallery
-

5. Tree Planting Breakdown

- **Tree Type:** Exotic species
 - **Quantity:** 40,000
 - **Purpose & Area:** Forest restoration blocks
 - **Acreage Covered:** 16.2 Ha (40.2 acres)
 - **Tree Type:** Indigenous species
 - **Quantity:** 10,000
 - **Purpose & Area:** Riparian zones for biodiversity protection and water catchment conservation
 - **Acreage Covered:** 4 Ha (9.8 acres)
-

6. Officials in Attendance

Kenya Forest Service (KFS)

- John Wachira – Forest Manager
- Gilbert K. Siele – KFS Inspector, Kipkabus Forest Station
- John Ouko – Assistant Forest Manager, Kipkabus Forest Station
- George Kirwa – Major, Kipkabus Forest Station
- Morphat Kiplimo – KFS Ranger
- George Kamau – KFS Ranger

Community Forest Association (CFA)

- Elijah B. Kapkoros – CFA Chairperson
- David Tanui – CFA Lead for Water Catchment Section
- Irine Boen – CFA Secretary
- Moses Kibet – CFA Vice Chairperson

Other Government Departments

- Alex Otieno Oyugi – County Director of Youth Affairs
- Stephen Kilonzo – County Director, National Environment Management Authority
- Simeon Cheptot – County Director, Meteorological Department

YGAK Officials

- Dennis Asiya – Co-founder
- Daniel Ooko – Board Secretary

7. Challenges

- The shift from student-centered planting to community mobilization required rapid coordination adjustments
 - Terrain and logistical access challenges required real-time flexibility and support
-

8. Successes

- All 50,000 trees were planted within 5 days
 - A mix of exotic and indigenous species ensured ecological balance
 - Strong partnerships were built with government agencies and local leadership
 - Increased local ownership and participation through CFA and community members
 - **TagDev East Africa's involvement introduced an academic-community collaboration model that strengthens field action and policy alignment**
-

9. Recommendations & Next Steps

- Establish a joint monitoring framework with CFA and KFS to track tree survival rates
 - Sustain visibility through documentation, storytelling, and progress updates
 - Proceed with **Phase Two** immediately to build on the momentum and community enthusiasm, and to take advantage of current weather conditions
 - Deepen collaboration with **TagDev East Africa** for future phases, integrating environmental learning, student involvement, and community-based research in restoration
-

10. Acknowledgements

We express heartfelt gratitude to:

- The Kipkabus community for their warm collaboration and tireless participation
- Government representatives from NEMA, the Meteorological Department, Ministry of Youth, and the Kenya Forest Service
- The Community Forest Association (CFA) for their unwavering leadership and coordination
- Our generous project sponsors and patrons:
TagDev East Africa (Transforming African Agricultural Universities), German Imaging Technologies, Victoria Furniture, and The Design Gallery – your invaluable support powered this campaign
- The Youths for Green Action team for translating vision into tangible environmental change